security and stability, I visited Pakistan on two occasions and even hosted a high ranking delegation at my headquarters in Belgium, which was a first I think in the alliance.

My sense is that what we have been witnessing is a migration from two bilateral problems, one in Pakistan and one in Afghanistan, to one big regional problem. And I think that the trend is that we are going to be dealing with Afghanistan and Pakistan as a regional problem that is going to require regional solutions. In Afghanistan the two Ambassadors have talked about our reports. I will simply say that internationally Afghanistan has all of the international legitimacy that is needed, certainly with U.S. Security Council resolutions, the presence of most of the important international organizations, the United States, the European Union, NATO, the World Bank, and non-governmental organizations, over 40 countries on the ground. All of the instruments that one would need to have success are present in Afghanistan. And yet one has the impression that while we are certainly not losing in a military sense, that we are not making the progress that we would like to make.

The recently-completed NATO summit in Bucharest has reaffirmed the alliance's commitment to being successful in Afghanistan. And indeed, on the 12th of June of this year the Paris Support Conference will convene and NATO allies will discuss ways in which they can make additional commitments to support a winning strategy in Afghanistan.

I continue to feel, as I have said many times, that while the military equation is important, far more important than that is the ability to come to a strategic plan to address four or five things that simply have to be done in Afghanistan if that country is going to turn in the right direction. The first of these, the first three are related. And I would say I would highlight the necessity to deal with the narcotic problem, as Ambassador Pickring has mentioned, but you cannot do that until you have a stable judiciary, which they do not have and they are not moving toward in my view. And then a police force that is capable of providing security and stability throughout the country that is both adequately trained, adequately equipped and resourced. And that is certainly something that has been lagging.

Fourth on my list of things that have to be done is the Karzai government in my view has to be held accountable to the international community for doing the things that it can do, for the expansion in the reach of its influence, for stamping out corruption in the government, and doing the things that the international community deserves to expect from a government that is benefiting so much by the sacrifice in both treasure and lives by so many countries around the world.

So in Afghanistan I think our strategy is to increase the capacity. Many discussions about whether we need more troops or not. Generally what the commanders have asked for is modest, given the capacity of the North Atlantic Treaty Organization. And I have always advocated both in uniform and out of uniform that they should be supported.

The recent addition of United States Marines, in fact one of the units I used to command, the 24th Marine Expeditionary Unit which I commanded in northern Iraq in 1991 during the Kurdish refugee operation, is in fact the unit that is going to be inserted in the south. And I so confident they will do a great job.

In terms of coherence, we need to make some gains with the United Nations I am happy to say taking the lead in coordinating international assistance to Afghanistan. This has to be a very strong lead. I know Ambassador Qaiyaidi very well and I wish him well in this important undertaking.

With regard to Pakistan, my sense is that this is in terms of the regional context it is still an evolving problem that we are dealing with and trying to understand. I think there is much

Copyright © 2010. Nova Science Publishers, Incorporated. All rights reserved.

Combating Islamic Militancy and Terrorism in Pakistan's Border Region, Nova Science Publishers, Incorporated, 2010. ProQuest Ebook Central,